MODULE-2 · MASTERCLASS DOSSIER

2.4 The 20 Station War Room

Lesson masterclass · implementation drills · war-room directive

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Build a concentration-based 20-station command center.
- Allocate every row by outcome: 10 slot / 6 ladder / 3 market-maker / 1 wildcard.
- Keep the war room at exactly 20 rows as the map grows.

★ **INSIDER RADIO TIP**

Allocate the war room by outcome: 10 slot shops, 6 ladder shops, 3 market-makers, 1 wildcard. Keep it at exactly 20 rows even as the map grows — growth is new campaigns, not bigger rows.

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2.4 The 20-Station War Room — Build the Command Center That Never Sleeps

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THE ONE-LINE TRUTH: Dominion is concentration of force. A locked war room of 20 scored, personalized stations will produce 5x more adds than an undisciplined database of 500 names.

MASTERCLASS DIRECTIVE & STRATEGIC BLUEPRINT

Strategic Foundation & Operational Reality

Amateur artists believe that successful radio promotion is a numbers game governed by sheer volume. They buy contact lists of 5,000 email addresses, copy-paste a generic pitch, and hit send. Within 72 hours, their email deliverability collapses, zero meaningful adds materialize, and the artist collapses in exhaustion, convinced that radio is an impenetrable cartel.

Dominion operators operate under the military principle of **Concentration of Force**.

Instead of spreading thin across hundreds of unvetted contacts, you concentrate your operational band-width on a tightly curated **20-Station War Room**. Twenty stations is the exact mathematical sweet spot for an independent operator:

- Large enough to guarantee statistical airplay yield (a 20% to 30% add conversion rate yields 4 to 6 solid station adds).
- Small enough that every single gatekeeper receives deep, tailored personalization, individual track analysis, and meticulous multi-touch follow-up.
- Fully manageable within 45 minutes of daily operational execution.

The Anatomy of the 20-Station War Room

Your War Room is not a passive spreadsheet; it is an active tactical cockpit. Every station in your War Room advances through a rigid **6-Stage Lifecycle Ladder**:

1. **Queued (Stage 1):** Scored >= 75 points. Named gatekeeper verified. 3-layer subject line drafted. Audio package staged.
2. **Dispatched (Stage 2):** Touch 1 payload delivered during optimal morning programming window. Timestamp logged.
3. **Engaged / Opened (Stage 3):** Payload opened or link clicked. Monitored via privacy-compliant analytics.
4. **Dialogue / In Review (Stage 4):** Gatekeeper replied, requested assets, or acknowledged submission. Immediate high-value reply dispatched.
5. **Confirmed Add / Spin (Stage 5):** Track placed in rotation, scheduled for specialty play, or booked for an on-air interview. Spinitron confirmation captured.
6. **Retired / Re-Check (Stage 6):** Polite decline received, or 3-touch sequence completed without engagement. Transferred to 90-day re-check calendar.

The Daily 45-Minute Battle Rhythm

To operate your War Room with peak efficiency, execute this daily protocol four days per week (Monday through Thursday):

- Minute 0 – 10 (Reconnaissance): Review Spinitron and playlist logs for target stations to check for spontaneous spins. Log all incoming replies.
- Minute 10 – 25 (Execution Wave): Dispatch scheduled Touch 1 initial sends or Touch 2/3 follow-ups strictly per the campaign calendar.
- Minute 25 – 40 (Asset & Dialogue Response): Respond to programmer inquiries, provide clean broadcast WAV files, coordinate interview windows, and dispatch custom station sweepers.
- Minute 40 – 45 (Ledger Reconciliation): Update every status column, log next-touch dates, and audit pipeline velocity.

IMPLEMENTATION DRILLS & PASS STANDARDS

- **Drill 1 — War Room Target Lockdown (45 min).** Review your Hometown Heat Map and Format Scorecards. Select your definitive 20 stations (12 Tier-1 priority targets, 8 Tier-2 regional targets). Populate the War Room Cockpit Worksheet below.
- **Drill 2 — Gatekeeper Verification Sweep (30 min).** Verify the direct email address and exact professional title of the music director or specialty show host for all 20 stations. Zero generic emails permitted.
- **Drill 3 — The Status Board Initialization (15 min).** Confirm that all 20 stations are classified as ‘Queued’ with scheduled launch dates locked into your calendar.
- **Drill 4 — Accountability Partnership Activation (10 min).** Share your 20-Station War Room roster with one trusted peer or community accountability partner.

ACTION WORKSHEET & OPERATIONAL PROTOCOL

Protocol Document: `20-STATION WAR ROOM OPERATIONAL COCKPIT`

Complete the structured table below as part of your lesson implementation. This worksheet directly replaces legacy spreadsheets with a publication-grade execution protocol.

Station Call-sign	Metro & Dial	Format & Program	Decision Maker	Current Status	Last Touch Date	Next Scheduled Action	Verification Source
WLUW 88.7 FM	Chicago, IL	Indie Rock / Drive	Sarah Jenkins (MD)	Queued	Pending Day 1	Launch Touch 1 @ 9:30 AM	Station Staff Directory

WNUR 89.3 FM	Evanston, IL	Progressive / Night	Alex Rivera (MD)	Queued	Pending Day 1	Launch Touch 1 @ 9:30 AM	Direct Email Verified
WMSE 91.7 FM	Milwaukee, WI	AAA / Local Focus	Tom Crawford (PD)	Queued	Pending Day 3	Stage Touch 1 Wave 2	Spinitron Contact Header
KUTX 98.9 FM	Austin, TX	Eclectic College	Rick McNulty (MD)	Queued	Pending Day 3	Stage Touch 1 Wave 2	KUTX Music Submission Page
WXPN 88.5 FM	Philadelphia, PA	AAA / World Cafe	Bruce Warren (PD)	Queued	Pending Day 3	Specialty Host Pitch Prep	Direct Programming Directory

WAR-ROOM NOTES

WAR-ROOM DIRECTIVE — 2.4 The 20-Station War Room — Build the Command Center That Never Sleeps

NEVER EXPAND BEYOND 20 UNTIL 20 ARE CONVERTED OR RETIRED

The fatal operational failure of independent operators is pipeline creep. They start with 20 stations, get excited, add 50 more, lose track of follow-up dates, send Touch 2 twelve days late, fail to log replies, and collapse the entire system into chaotic noise.

THE OPERATOR'S DISCIPLINE:

1. **The 20-Cap Rule:** You are prohibited from adding station #21 until one of your active 20 stations either confirms an add (graduating to the Thank-You & Proof compounding loops) or completes Touch 3 and enters the 90-day cold archive.
2. **Visual Command:** Print your 20-Station War Room Cockpit and physically mount it to your studio wall. Marking stations from Dispatched to Dialogue to Confirmed Add with a physical marker creates psychological momentum that digital spreadsheets cannot replicate.

FREQUENCY DOMINION COMMUNITY DRILLS

1. Post a screenshot or transcript of your 20-Station War Room Cockpit roster.
2. Identify which 3 stations in your War Room represent your highest-conviction airplay opportunities.
3. State your confirmed Launch Day (Day 1) date when Touch 1 dispatches to your first wave.
4. Commit to the 45-Minute Daily Battle Rhythm by sharing the exact time block scheduled in your calendar.

Key Takeaways

REMEMBER THIS

- Concentration beats breadth.
- Allocate by outcome: slot, ladder, market-maker, wildcard.
- Growth means new campaigns, not bigger rows.

Self-Assessment · Check Your Mastery

PASS BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- 1. Is my war room exactly twenty rows?
- 2. Does each row carry an outcome role (slot / ladder / market-maker / wildcard)?
- 3. Is my wildcard slot actually a wildcard, not another slot shop?